

Hints for Presentation

Disclaimer: These are only hints.
Opinions about what constitutes good
presentations vary
(also depends on the context)

Organizing the Content

- CEO: „You are talking to the CEO. Get to the point!“
- You cannot be sure that you will make it through the whole presentation (don't save the best for last)
- Pyramid Principle
 - Take home message at the beginning
 - Key messages first, details follow
 - Key message of the slide at the top (or in the title)

Structure

- Slide 1-3
 - Board Meeting:
 - *Attention Getter (optional)*
 - „Problem/Context,
 - Approach to solution
 - Key findings (or the nature of the findings)

Slide should be self-sufficient

- self-sufficient, but not overloaded
 - → do not use full sentences
 - → pyramid principle helps to get key points across

End of the Presentation

- Thank you slide?
 - may be better to use the space for preparing the discussion that should follow
 - Alternative options
 - Agenda overview
 - Take home message
- Backup Slides
 - Anticipate questions and prepare material for more detailed discussion

Timing

- The more important the audience, to more important is precise timing
- The shorter the time frame, the more important is the timing
- → practice

Organising content for this presentation

- First: Give just a high level overview of the technical concept → Brief overview how did you arrive at your results (e.g. one slide)
- Second: Focus on business results
 - **but backed up with information how you derived** it (e.g. what data was this based on) → no data without context
 - Provide all information needed to understand the scope and nature of your analysis
- Third: Present some technical details later on (as requested by customers)
 - Go top down in the abstraction level with some very “deep” parts (to give a glimpse of the complexity)
 - Exploratory data analysis does not require much technical details (more on ML)
 - If you show code: only to stress a specific point and with easy to capture annotations

This slide is not for a board meeting

- Overloaded with text
- Little visual aid to comprehend structure
- Message not clear at first glance
- Needs complete reading to comprehend

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Show how you derived findings

Audience needs context of analysis to understand results

